Sssenses

Most reptiles can see, hear, and smell, but they also have other ways of detecting things. Some reptiles rely on one sense that is very well-developed, while others use a mixture of sense skills to get by.



The eardrum is very thin and flexible.

Fully aware

Iguanas have very clear sight and full-color vision. Like most lizards, they detect sounds in the air using an eardrum in the skin behind the eye.

Snakes use their senses of smell, taste, and touch more than their eyesight and hearing.

The taste test

A snake's tongue flicks in and out to collect up chemicals in the air. A sense organ inside the mouth "smells" and "tastes" these chemicals, helping the snake to sample food, find a mate, and to detect prey or enemies.

The body heat of this rat can be sensed by a snake's heat pits.